occupation. But the "concern for, and investment of resources in, the aesthetic qualities of the buildings" signaled that a settled, rather than transhumant or nomadic, population resided in these permanent dwellings during much of the year. Furthermore, remnants of a large, arcaded structure on the Hari Rud's north bank were not for defensive purposes, but rather "more reminiscent of the shop fronts in the traditional souqs of the Islamic world."[20] The archaeological evidence thus far, then, supports the idea that Firuzkuh was an already existing mercantile settlement – Juzjani's cosmopolitan Jewish merchant serving as its personification (cf. Chapter 2) – with which the early Shansabanis established a mutually profitable association, and which probably brought further growth in the area's settled and nomadic populations.

The one complex for which no specific archaeological evidence could be found was Juzjani's lofty and crenellated Kushk-i Sultan, supposedly located atop a natural elevation (Pers. *baz*) in the center of Firuzkuh and serving as the Shansabanis' *qasr*. Instead, indications of elite occupation were concentrated largely in defensive structures on surrounding promontories. The ruins known collectively as Qasr-i Zarafshan (Figures 3.2 and 3.3), for example, stretch along the north bank of the Hari Rud, the most substantial remnant being a conical tower of mud bricks on a stone footing. The tower is comparable with the defensive remains documented in the south of Ghur (Chapter 2) and west of Bamiyan (see below), though it lacks the plaster surfaces with molded or incised designs. However, the Qasr's local name of Arg-i Dukhtar-i Padshah – "Citadel of the Emperor's Daughter" – seems to carry a royal association.[21] Farther above the Qasr stands the "refuge" called Kuh-i Khara ("Black Mountain"?), which provided more certain signs of elite occupation: a large cistern lined on three sides with baked bricks (Figure 3.4); turquoise-glazed brick fragments; and a significant number of high-status ceramic sherds such as *mina'i* ware. Although, the disturbance caused by numerous robber holes makes it difficult to put forth definitive conclusions regarding the full range of occupation at these primarily defensive structures.[22]

The Jam-Firuzkuh remains are not altogether unusual in light of the Shansabanis' continued transhumance and/or nomadism throughout the twelfth century, consisting of seasonal movements between their summer encampment or "capital" of Firuzkuh and its winter counterpart in Zamindawar (cf. Chapter 2). Again, their contemporaries the Saljuqs offer a parallel *modus vivendi*. The Saljuqs of Iran (*c.* 1038–1194) largely preferred a textile palatial architecture in the form of luxurious royal tents, and at times cloth enclosures (*saraparda*) incorporating architecture with a limited footprint such as a *kushk*, a single- or two-story pavilion for viewing (or being viewed).[23] The name of Kushk-i Sultan for the Firuzkuh *qasr* could very well have referred to just such a structure – swept away by the flood of 1199 CE and/or the Mongols. Thus, Juzjani *metaphorically* – rather than